Two-Computer Installation Guide

Live Auction Host + Cashier Workstation

Use this sequence exactly: install both PCs, collect both Machine IDs, activate both PCs, configure the host, then pair the cashier.

Installer	HammerTrackPro-0.7.28-x64-signed.msi
Supported setup	Two Windows x64 computers on the same private local network
Computer 1	Live Auction Host - owns the auction database
Computer 2	Cashier Workstation - connects securely to the host

Important

Never place or share the HammerTrack database on a network drive. The host keeps the database locally; the cashier communicates with the host through HammerTrack's paired HTTPS connection.

Print this guide in color or grayscale at 100% scale on US Letter paper.

1. Before you begin

Gather everything before auction day. Perform the installation while both computers can remain on the same private network.

You will need

[ ] The HammerTrack Pro 0.7.28 signed MSI installer on a USB drive or other trusted transfer method.

[ ] Administrator permission on both Windows computers.

[ ] One host computer for live-auction operation and one cashier computer.

[ ] Both computers connected to the same trusted private router or LAN.

[ ] A signed .htplicense file that includes the Machine ID of both computers.

Choose and label the computers

LIVE AUCTION HOST	Runs the auction, stores the local database, and must stay powered on while the cashier is working.
CASHIER	Looks up current-auction buyers and sellers and records payments through the secure connection to the host.

Do not use public Wi-Fi. If possible, connect both PCs by Ethernet to the same router for the most reliable auction-day connection.

Record for this installation

Auction company	_____
Host PC name	_____
Cashier PC name	_____
Installation date	_____

2. Install and activate both computers

1. Install on the host
Copy HammerTrackPro-0.7.28-x64-signed.msi to the live-auction computer. Double-click it, approve the Windows administrator prompt, and complete the installer.

2. Install on the cashier
Repeat the same signed MSI installation on the cashier computer.

3. Launch HammerTrack Pro
Use the Desktop or Start Menu shortcut. The installer is locally self-signed. If Windows displays an unknown-publisher warning on a computer that does not trust the local certificate, confirm the MSI came from your trusted HammerTrack provider before continuing.

4. Collect both Machine IDs
At the activation screen, select Copy Machine ID on each computer. Label each ID as Host or Cashier and send both IDs to the license issuer.

5. Receive one license file
The issuer creates one signed .htplicense file containing both Machine IDs. Keep the file private and unchanged.

6. Activate both computers
On each activation screen, import the same .htplicense file. HammerTrack confirms the licensed customer name.

A license for only one Machine ID will not activate the other PC. If either computer is replaced, request a replacement license containing the complete approved Machine ID list.

Activation record

Host Machine ID	_____
Cashier Machine ID	_____
License file received	_____ Date: _____

3. Configure the Live Auction Host

1. Select the host role
On first setup, choose Live Auction Host (stores the database), then save the selection. Restart HammerTrack if prompted or if you later change the role.

2. Allow private-network access
If Windows Firewall asks, allow HammerTrack on Private networks. Do not enable it for public networks.

3. Open Network Information
In HammerTrack, open Network Information. Leave this screen available while setting up the cashier.

4. Copy the pairing values
Record the Host address, Alternate IP address, Pairing key, and Certificate fingerprint exactly as displayed. Keep the pairing key private.

5. Keep the host running
HammerTrack must remain open on this computer whenever the cashier workstation is being used.

Host pairing record

Host address	_____
Alternate IP address	_____
Pairing key	_____ _____
Certificate fingerprint	_____ _____

The live-auction host is the only computer that opens the SQLite database. Never copy the live database to a shared, UNC, mapped-network, or cloud-synced folder.

4. Pair the Cashier Workstation

1. Confirm the host is ready
The host PC must be running HammerTrack and both computers must be on the same private network.

2. Select the cashier role
On the cashier setup screen, choose Cashier Workstation (connects to host).

3. Enter the secure connection values
Copy the Host address, Pairing key, and Certificate fingerprint from Network Information on the host. Include the full HTTPS address.

4. Save and restart
Save the workstation setup. Restart HammerTrack after changing the workstation role or connection settings.

5. Verify connection status
Open the cashier screen and confirm it connects to the host. The cashier retries health checks after a temporary disconnect.

If the computer-name Host address does not connect, edit cashier setup and use the Alternate IP address shown on the host. Keep the same pairing key and certificate fingerprint.

Run a pre-auction cashier test

[ ] On the host, select the correct Current Auction.

[ ] On the cashier, confirm the connected state and current-auction context.

[ ] Look up a test Buyer registered for that auction and confirm the expected purchases and totals.

[ ] Open Add Buyer and Add Seller; confirm existing Buyer Numbers appear for Seller linking.

[ ] Verify an existing Buyer can be registered as a Seller using the same number without creating a duplicate Buyer.

[ ] Use Full Screen or F11 and confirm Escape exits full screen.

[ ] If using license scanning, open Add Buyer, confirm the intended camera works, and test a sample license barcode.

[ ] Do not record a real payment during the connection test unless it is intended and auditable.

Security note

The cashier pins the host certificate fingerprint and uses the pairing key. Do not bypass certificate or pairing errors; compare the values against the host's Network Information screen.

5. Troubleshooting and auction-day checklist

If the cashier will not connect

Disconnected	Confirm HammerTrack is open on the host and both PCs are connected to the same private router/LAN.
Host name fails	Use the Alternate IP address from the host's Network Information screen.
Not paired	Re-enter the pairing key exactly. Do not add spaces before or after it.
Fingerprint error	Re-enter the certificate fingerprint exactly as displayed on the host. Do not ignore a mismatch.
Still offline	Confirm Windows classified the network as Private and HammerTrack is allowed through the host firewall on Private networks.

If activation fails

PC not included	Send the displayed Machine ID to the license issuer and request a replacement license that retains all approved PCs.
Invalid file	Import the original .htplicense file without renaming its extension or editing its contents.
Expired license	Contact the license issuer for a renewed signed license.

Before bidders arrive

[ ] Host PC is connected to power and sleep is disabled for the event.

[ ] Cashier PC is connected and shows a healthy connection.

[ ] Correct Current Auction is selected on the host.

[ ] A recent in-app backup exists in the local Backups folder.

[ ] Network Information is available to the operator but the pairing key is not publicly visible.

[ ] Buyer lookup and same-number Seller linking succeed from the cashier.

Data location: %ProgramData%\HammerTrackPro. Application upgrades and uninstall preserve the database, backups, logs, settings, and license, but maintain current backups before any upgrade or service work.

Installation completed by: _____ Date: _____